

Company HR Policy Handbook

Sample policy reference | Project Akatsuki | Microsoft Innovate 2026

This handbook summarizes the policies our HR FAQ Assistant answers from. Some policies apply to every employee; others are restricted to Managers or HR, matching exactly what the chatbot is allowed to answer for each role.

Who Can See What

Role	Can ask the bot about
Employee	Annual Leave, Work From Home, Sick Leave, Maternity/Paternity Leave, Expense Reimbursement, Resignation & Notice, IT Equipment
Manager	Everything above, plus: Performance Improvement Plans, Salary Band & Compensation Reviews
HR	Everything above, plus: Termination & Disciplinary Procedures

General Policies — All Employees

Annual Leave (Earned Leave)

Full-time employees get 12 days of paid annual/earned leave per calendar year. Leave must be requested at least 3 working days in advance through the HR portal, except in genuine emergencies.

Casual Leave

Employees get 7 days of casual leave per year, separate from annual leave, for short-notice personal matters. No more than 3 casual leave days can be taken consecutively.

Continuous Leave Limit

Employees cannot take more than 10 consecutive working days of leave (combining any leave type) without prior written approval from both their manager and HR, submitted at least 2 weeks in advance.

Half-Day and Short Leave

A half-day leave deducts 0.5 days from the annual leave balance and must be applied through the HR portal. Short leave under 3 hours only needs manager notification.

Sick Leave (Medical Leave)

Employees get 7 days of paid sick/medical leave per year. A doctor's note is required beyond 2 consecutive days, and no more than 5 sick days can be taken consecutively without a full medical certificate.

Leave Carry-Forward and Encashment

Up to 5 unused annual leave days can be carried forward to the next year; the rest lapse on December 31. Leave is not cashed out except as part of final settlement.

Work From Home

Employees may work from home up to 2 days per week with manager approval. WFH requests should be submitted at least 1 day in advance through the HR portal.

Maternity and Paternity Leave

Maternity leave is 26 weeks, fully paid, in line with the Maternity Benefit Act. Paternity leave is 10 working days, fully paid, to be taken within 3 months of the child's birth.

Expense Reimbursement

Work-related expenses up to Rs. 5,000 can be submitted through the finance portal along with a valid receipt. Reimbursement is processed within 10 working days of manager approval.

Resignation and Notice Period

The standard notice period is 30 days for confirmed employees and 15 days during probation. The notice period can be bought out with written manager and HR approval.

IT Equipment and Asset Policy

Employees are issued a laptop and basic accessories on joining. Any damage or loss must be reported to IT within 24 hours. Equipment must be returned in working condition on resignation or termination.

Manager & HR Policies

Visible to Manager and HR roles only

Performance Improvement Plans

Managers may initiate a formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) for an underperforming employee, in consultation with HR. A PIP typically runs 30-60 days with documented weekly check-ins, and must be logged in the HR system before being communicated to the employee.

Salary Band and Compensation Reviews

Compensation reviews happen annually in April. Managers can propose a salary change within their team's approved budget band; any change above that band needs HR and department-head approval before it is communicated.

HR-Only Policies

Visible to HR role only

Termination and Disciplinary Procedures

All termination decisions must be reviewed and approved by HR before being communicated to the employee. Disciplinary actions follow a documented three-step process: verbal warning, written warning, final review. Immediate termination without this process requires director-level sign-off.

How the Assistant Uses This Document

The HR FAQ Assistant doesn't memorize this handbook — it reads it fresh every time, in four steps:

1. Match

The employee's question is compared against every policy section this document contains, scoped to what their role is allowed to see.

2. Confidence check

If nothing matches well enough, the assistant says so and points the employee to HR, instead of guessing.

3. Answer generation

If there's a confident match, an AI model turns that policy section into a short, plain-language answer — never adding information this document doesn't contain.

4. Citation + logging

The answer is shown with the exact section it came from, and the question is logged so HR can see what people are actually asking about.

Sample Questions You Can Try, by Role

Role	Try asking...
Employee	• How many leave days do I get? • Can I work from home? • What happens if I lose my laptop?
Manager	• Can I start a performance improvement plan for someone? • Can I change someone's salary?
HR	• How is termination handled? • What's the disciplinary process?

Note: this is sample policy data written for the hackathon demo, not an actual company's real HR policy.